test and quarantine the returnees were made in recipient states so as to avoid the spread of the virus to remote parts of the country. In Maharashtra, political spats turned ugly when Thackeray announced in a televised message that they had been asking the Centre for 80 trains to operate daily, but the Centre was only sending 30-odd ones. Responding to this criticism, the Centre planned 125 trains to be operated in a couple of days, provided the state gave the list of migrants who would be boarding these trains in the next hour. However, several hours passed, but the Maharashtra state government was unable to send over the list.[7] Union Railway Minster, Piyush Goyal, tweeted,

> More than 2.5 hours have passed but still passenger details for 125 planned trains in Maharashtra not received by GM Central Railway from Government of Maharashtra. I hope that these trains will not have to leave empty after arriving at the station like it has happened earlier. I would like to assure you that the trains you need will be available.[8]

The Central Railway issued a press release noting that it had to cancel 65 scheduled trains due to the incapability of the state government to deliver a list of passengers. They added, 'For the last two hours, rail authorities have been waiting for the list of passengers with details of their destination to plan the trains. Planning special trains is an elaborate process, which requires time and unless lists are given in time, Maharashtra government will make it impossible for Railways to run trains.'[9] Eventually, at 2:00 a.m., Goyal tweeted once again: 'Where is the list for 125 trains from Maharashtra? As of 2am, received list of only 46 trains of which 5 are to West Bengal and Odisha which cannot operate due to cyclone Amphan. We are notifying only 41 trains for today despite being prepared for 125 !!!'[10]

Early in the month, when the GoI had just begun the Shramik trains, the official guidelines to cover costs were, 'Sending state may decide to bear this cost or take it from passengers or take it from receiving state after mutual consultation or may charge it to any fund. It is purely their prerogative. Without a ticket, passengers cannot go, so we are issuing tickets to each passenger.'[11] However, coming down heavily on the decision of the Centre to charge the states for migrant travel or possibly take ticket costs from migrants, Congress interim president Sonia Gandhi issued a letter stating that state Congress units would cover the cost of migrants on-